

A

Verb + noun suffix

Suffixes are used at the ends of words; they often tell you if a word is a noun, a verb, an adjective or an adverb. Two suffixes which form nouns from verbs are **-ion** and **-ment**.

verb	noun
invent [produce or design something completely new]	invention
discuss [talk about something seriously]	discussion
translate [change from one language to another]	translation
relax [rest, and feel calm and comfortable]	relaxation
improve [get better]	improvement
govern [control the affairs of a city or country]	government
manage [direct or control a business]	management
develop [grow or change and become more advanced]	development

His latest **invention** is a new board game.
Relaxation will help you to sleep better.
 We had a **discussion about** politics.

The **management** has to change.
 I need money for more **development**.
 We need an **improvement in** the weather.

B

Adjective + noun suffix

The suffixes **-ness** and **-ity** often form nouns from adjectives.

adjective	noun
weak (<i>opp</i> strong)	weakness
happy	happiness
ill [sick, not well]	illness
fit [in good condition, usually because of exercise]	fitness
stupid (<i>opp</i> intelligent, clever)	stupidity
popular [liked by a lot of people]	popularity
similar [almost the same; <i>opp</i> different]	similarity
able	ability (<i>opp</i> inability)

What is his main **weakness** as a manager?
 Snowboarding is growing in **popularity**.
 I'm frustrated by my **inability to** use computers.

Fortunately it wasn't a serious **illness**.
 There is a **similarity between** them.
 Her **happiness** is all that matters to me.

C

-er, -or and -ist

These suffixes can be added to nouns or verbs. They often describe people and jobs.

-er	-or	-ist
ballet dancer pop singer professional footballer	company director translator film actor	artist , e.g. Picasso economist scientist

Language help

Adding a suffix to a verb, adjective or noun may change the position of the main stress, e.g. re'lax – relax'ation, 'stupid – stu'pidity, eco'nomics – e'conomist.
 (The ' symbol is before the syllable with the main stress.)

Exercises

71.1 Complete the tables and mark the stress on each word. (Stress is marked on the pronunciation of a word in a dictionary.) The last two in each column are not on the opposite page, but do you know or can you guess the noun formed from them?

verb	noun	adjective	noun
dis'cuss	<i>dis'cussion</i>	stupid	
improve		happy	
invent		similar	
relax		popular	
hesitate		sad	
arrange		active	

71.2 Write down the names of the people who do these things as a job.

- 1 sing opera music *opera singers*
- 2 act in films
- 3 important managers in a company
- 4 change words from one language into another
- 5 play football
- 6 dance in ballets
- 7 paint pictures
- 8 work in science

71.3 Complete the text using words from the box with the correct suffix and spelling. One word also needs a prefix.

weak	improve	govern	economics	able	manage	discuss
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“In his speech last night, the prime minister said that the present ¹ *weakness* of the economy was caused by the bad ² of the last ³ and their ⁴ to give the right kind of help for industry. He said he was now involved in detailed ⁵ with ministers, bankers and ⁶ about a range of different financial measures, and he hoped the people would be able to see a big ⁷ in the economy by the end of the year.”

71.4 Complete the dialogues.

- 1 A: He hasn't been well at all, has he?
B: No, it's quite a serious *illness*.
- 2 A: Are they almost the same?
B: Yes, the is amazing.
- 3 A: Has anyone made anything like this before?
B: No, it's a brand-new.
- 4 A: Is her new novel going to be published in other languages?
B: Yes, someone is working on a right now.
- 5 A: Does your daughter enjoy drawing too?
B: Yes, she's a very good.
- 6 A: Javier gets tired after he's been playing for about ten minutes.
B: I know. If he wants to be in the team, he'll have to improve his.
- 7 A: Do you think the organisation can still grow?
B: Yes, I think there is an opportunity for further.